

The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Subject Description Form

Please read the notes at the end of the table carefully before completing the form.

Subject Code	ENGL2BN02
Subject Title	New Media: New Meanings
Credit Value	3
Level	2
Pre-requisite / Co-requisite/ Exclusion	
Cluster Area	Please check the box(es) below to indicate the cluster area(s) the subject contributes in a major way: ☐ Human Nature, Relations and Development ☒ Community, Organization and Globalisation ☐ History, Cultures and World Views ☐ Science, Technology and Environment
Requirements intended to fulfil	☐ China-Study Requirement (CSR) - More than 60% CSR-related content ☒ Eligible for “English Writing” (EW) designation - include an extensive piece of writing (1,500 – 2,500 words) AND “English Reading” (ER) designation - include a reading of an extensive text (100,000 words or 200 pages) ☐ Eligible for “Chinese Writing” (CW) designation - include an extensive piece of writing (2,000 – 3,000 characters) AND “Chinese Reading” (CR) designation - include a reading of an extensive text (100,000 characters or 200 pages) ☐ Others _____
Medium of Instruction	Please check the appropriate box: ☒ English ☐ Cantonese ☐ Putonghua ☐ Others (Please specify: _____)
Objectives	New media describes the emergence of digital communication technologies, which involves interactive forms of communication through the Internet. Some examples of new media include websites, chat rooms, web advertising, etc. The advent of new media communication has changed every aspect of modern life. The ability to communicate complex information to a mass audience in digital environments is critical to success in today’s global community. The subject aims to develop students’ critical understanding of the forms, meanings, and use of language in new media; their knowledge and skills to apply appropriate theories for analysing and discussing new meaning-making in action; and their ability to reflect on the effects of new media which extends the capabilities of communication.

Intended Learning Outcomes (Note 1)	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a) demonstrate an understanding of new media from a technical perspective, and how new media impacts meaning-making; b) critically apply and discuss theories and frameworks to analyse meanings in new media; c) develop a critical awareness of how to best utilise new media for effective communication; and d) develop a more global, socially responsible, and creative perspective to maximize the potential of new media																												
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus (Note 2)	1. What are new media? The characteristics of new media, change and continuity. 2. Language use in new media • Formation of new vocabularies • Internet slangs • The language of email • Speech acts in online communication • Metaphors on the Internet 3. Visual communication in new media • Emoticons • Photographs in digital communication 4. Globalization and culture in new media texts 5. New media and e-commerce 6. Storytelling in new media 7. Advantages and disadvantages of new media																												
Teaching/Learning Methodology (Note 3)	Basic examples, concepts, theories, and analytical tools are explained in the lectures, illustrated by research findings and case studies based on real-world new media contexts. Interactive activities are provided to enable students to develop insights into the technology behind new media, and the challenges of meaning-making in new media settings. Students are encouraged to share their own experiences of new media and to critically analyse these experiences.																												
Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes (Note 4)	<table><tr><th rowspan="2">Specific assessment methods/tasks</th><th rowspan="2">% weighting</th><th colspan="4">Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)</th></tr><tr><th>a</th><th>b</th><th>c</th><th>d</th></tr><tr><td>1. Quiz</td><td>25%</td><td>✓</td><td></td><td>✓</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>2. Oral presentation</td><td>20%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>3. Final paper (including EWR)</td><td>40%</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td><td>✓</td></tr></table>	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)				a	b	c	d	1. Quiz	25%	✓		✓		2. Oral presentation	20%	✓	✓	✓		3. Final paper (including EWR)	40%	✓	✓	✓	✓
Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting			Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed (Please tick as appropriate)																									
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1. Quiz	25%	✓		✓																									
2. Oral presentation	20%	✓	✓	✓																									
3. Final paper (including EWR)	40%	✓	✓	✓	✓																								

	4. Class participation	15%	✓	✓	✓	✓	
	Total	100 %					
	Explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes: Task 1 (Quiz) is assessing intended learning outcomes (a) and (c). This task checks students’ understanding of the new media concepts learned in the first half of the semester. It requires student to identify and interpret major issues in new media texts so as to be more aware of the emerging features in new media communication. Task 2 (Oral Presentation) is to assess intended learning outcomes (a), (b) and (c). It is an oral task, for which students are required to work on a lecture topic and present their ideas to the audience. Students have to draw to theories to discuss new media phenomenon and offer recommendations for effective communication. Task 3 (Final paper) assesses intended learning outcomes (a), (b), (c), and (d) and also fulfills the ER and EW requirements. Task 3 will involve literature research, application and evaluation of theories, new media data analysis, and critical discussion. In order to successfully complete the final paper students will need to complete the assigned readings. As part of Task 3, students will submit two drafts. Draft 1 will consist of an essay outline supported by academic sources and based on a template and guiding provided by the instructor. Draft 2 will be based upon the first draft but significantly expanded. Draft 2 will be a minimum of 1,500 words. Task 4 (Class Participation) is assessing intended learning outcomes (a), (b), (c) and (d). It includes weekly in-class discussion activities. These tasks reinforce the understanding of new media concepts, generate critical discussion, and create new perspectives on new media communication.						
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:						
	▪ Lecture (13x 2 hrs)			26Hrs.			
	▪ Seminar (13 x 1hr)			13Hrs.			
	Other student study effort:						
	▪ Assignments plus reading			90Hrs.			
	Total student study effort			129Hrs.			
Reading List and References	The following reading materials fulfill the ER designation (a reading of an extensive text of 100,000 words or 200 pages) and form an integral component of the quiz and final paper:						

	1. Jenkins, H. (2008). <i>Convergence culture: where old and new media collide</i>. New York: New York University Press. (Chapters 1, pp. 25-58; Chapter 3 & 4 pp.93-168) 2. Castells, M. (2010). <i>The rise of the network society</i>. Wiley (Chapters 1 and 2, pp. 1-76) 3. van Dijk, J. (2020). <i>The network society</i>. SAGE. 4th edition. (Chapter 1 and 2, pp. 1-56) Reading lists and references Bhatia, V. (2004) <i>Worlds of written discourse</i>. London: Continuum. Cheng, W. and Suen, A. (2014) Multimodal analysis of hotel homepages: A comparison of hotel websites across different star categories. [Special Issue]. <i>The Asian ESP Journal</i> 10(1) pp. 5-33. Creeber, G. and Martin, R. (2008). <i>Digital culture: understanding new media</i>. Oxford: Oxford University Press. Fuery, K. (2008). <i>New media: culture and image</i>. London: Palgrave Macmillan. Grundy, P. (2008) <i>Doing pragmatics</i>. London: Hodder Education. Kress, G. and van Leeuwen, T. (2006). <i>Reading images</i>. 2nd edition. London: Routledge. Logan, R. K. (2016) <i>Understanding new media: extending Marshall McLuhan</i>. 2nd edition. New York: Peter Lang.
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Revised by Ming Curran, January 2024

Note 1: Intended Learning Outcomes

Intended learning outcomes should state what students should be able to do or attain upon completion of the subject. Subject outcomes are expected to contribute to the attainment of the overall programme outcomes.

Note 2: Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus

The syllabus should adequately address the intended learning outcomes. At the same time over-crowding of the syllabus should be avoided.

Note 3: Teaching/Learning Methodology

This section should include a brief description of the teaching and learning methods to be employed to facilitate learning, and a justification of how the methods are aligned with the intended learning outcomes of the subject.

Note 4: Assessment Method

This section should include the assessment method(s) to be used and its relative weighting, and indicate which of the subject intended learning outcomes that each method purports to assess. It should also provide a brief explanation of the appropriateness of the assessment methods in assessing the intended learning outcomes.